

INTRODUCTION · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Claude Certified Architect – Foundations

CCAR-F. A complete exam-focused course, built from the official exam blueprint and current Anthropic documentation.

EXAM CCAR-F VIDEOS 25 RUNTIME 9h 22m

Every scenario here is **original**. Nothing was copied from a question bank.

What the exam is

- ◆ **60 questions in 120 minutes.** Two minutes per question, and that budget shapes every strategy in this course.
- ◆ **Multiple choice and multiple response.** Each item tells you how many answers to select. Read that line every time.
- ◆ **Scaled score out of 1000. You pass at 720.**
- ◆ **Delivered by Pearson VUE,** online proctored or at a test centre. Currently gated to Claude Partner Network members.
- ◆ **Valid for twelve months,** and there is no prerequisite certification.

ON THE EXAM

Confirm the current fee, policy and access rules on Anthropic's certification page before you book. Those move.

Who this exam is for, and what to have built

Anthropic suggests six months of hands-on work. Concretely:

- ◆ **An agent, end to end.** Real tool calls, real errors, a loop you had to stop.
- ◆ **Claude Code on a real project.** Memory files, path-scoped rules, a hook, an MCP server.
- ◆ **Tool descriptions you had to rewrite** because Claude kept picking the wrong one.
- ◆ **An extraction pipeline** with a schema, nullable fields, and a retry loop.
- ◆ **You do not need all of it.** This course fills gaps, not experience.

ON THE EXAM

The exam is written by people who have debugged these systems. It shows in how the distractors are built.

The five domains, and what each is worth

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	ROUGHLY
D1 Agentic Architecture & Orchestration	27%	16 questions
D2 Tool Design & MCP Integration	18%	11 questions
D3 Claude Code Configuration & Workflows	20%	12 questions
D4 Prompt Engineering & Structured Output	20%	12 questions
D5 Context Management & Reliability	15%	9 questions

ON THE EXAM

Domain 1 alone is more than a quarter of your score. This course gives it four modules.

Six scenarios. You get four of them.

Every question sits inside one of these production situations.

- ◆ **Customer support resolution agent.** Returns, billing disputes, and knowing when not to resolve.
- ◆ **Code generation with Claude Code.** Configuration, memory files, plan mode.
- ◆ **Multi-agent research system.** A coordinator delegating to specialised subagents.
- ◆ **Developer productivity tools.** Navigating unfamiliar codebases with built-in tools and MCP.
- ◆ **Claude Code in CI/CD.** Automated review, headless mode, cost and turn caps.
- ◆ **Structured data extraction.** Messy documents in, schema-valid JSON out.

ON THE EXAM

Four are drawn at random from these six. You cannot predict which, so all six get covered.

Almost every question is a **debugging** question. You are given a symptom and asked for the cause.

The qualifier decides the answer

Two or three options are usually workable. One word in the question separates them.

- ◆ **"Guarantee", "tamper-proof", "regardless of how the agent is prompted"** – the answer is a host-side control, never a prompt.
- ◆ **"Directly addresses the root cause"** – a workaround that fixes the symptom is a distractor, however well it works.
- ◆ **"Most effective", "most reliable"** – the one that generalises, not the one that handles the stated case.
- ◆ **"Most cost-effective" with no latency constraint** – batch is in play. Add a waiting customer and it is not.

ON THE EXAM

Module 19 is devoted to this. It is the cheapest marks in the whole course.

The course map

BLOCK	VIDEOS	RUNTIME
Introduction - this video	1	11 min
D1 Agentic architecture & orchestration	4	1h 40m
D2 Tool design & MCP integration	3	1h 11m
D3 Claude Code configuration & workflows	4	1h 21m
D4 Prompt engineering & structured output	3	1h 04m
D5 Context management & reliability	3	59 min
Cross-cutting - the modules the syllabus omits	3	51 min
Practice exams - 80 questions	4	2h 02m

ON THE EXAM

Twenty five videos, nine hours twenty two, 114 worked scenarios plus 80 practice exam questions.

Three modules the syllabus does not name

- ◆ **Module 18 – telling near-identical answers apart.** Fourteen pairs, side by side, with the rule that separates each one.
- ◆ **Module 19 – how this exam writes questions.** Scenario anatomy, qualifiers, the four distractor families, time budgeting.
- ◆ **Module 20 – what changed since the exam guide.** Where the current documentation and the examinable answer disagree.
- ◆ None of the three teaches new products. All three convert understanding you already have into marks.

ON THE EXAM

Module 18 contains almost no new content. That is the point of it.

Read this before you open the docs

The exam guide is version one. The products moved. Four places where they disagree.

- ◆ **Structured outputs.** The API now constrains JSON with a compiled grammar. The exam still wants the tool-schema technique.
- ◆ **/memory and /context split.** The exam's diagnostic answer is /memory. Current Claude Code reports loaded files under /context.
- ◆ **Auto memory.** Claude Code now writes its own per-repository notes. Postdates the guide entirely, and is not examinable.
- ◆ **Agent teams.** Experimental and behind a flag. Not examinable. Do not spend study time on it.

ON THE EXAM

This course teaches the examinable answer and flags the reality. Both are marked where they appear.

Answer from the **documented blueprint**.
Build from the current documentation. This
course marks which is which.

How the worked scenarios run

01

The situation

A production system, a symptom, and a constraint that decides it.

02

The question

Four options read aloud. Then the video pauses.

03

You commit

Pick one. Out loud, or on paper. Do not skip this step.

04

The walkthrough

Why the right one is right, and why each wrong one is tempting.

ON THE EXAM

Watching a walkthrough without committing first teaches almost nothing. It feels like learning because it is easy.

A study route, not just a contents list

- ◆ **Watch modules one to twenty in order.** Later modules assume vocabulary from earlier ones.
- ◆ **Then sit practice exam one under timed conditions.** Two minutes a question, no pausing, no notes.
- ◆ **Rewatch only the domain your misses cluster in.** Where they cluster matters more than the score.
- ◆ **Space the remaining three exams out.** One every few days beats three in an afternoon.
- ◆ **Revising what you already know feels productive and moves nothing.** The scores stay high, which is exactly why it is seductive.

ON THE EXAM

Anthropic suggests six months of hands-on building. If you have that, this course fills the gaps. If not, build something first.

This exam rewards **judgement**, not recall.
Nothing here is worth memorising on its
own.